Visayas State University
Artificial Intelligence Policy Framework

Enabling responsible, effective use of AI in instruction, research, and administration

Policy owner: Technical Working Group for AI Policy and Governance,
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Status of this document. This is a **DRAFT for panel review**. It is not approved policy and has no binding effect until formally approved and issued by the competent university authority. Statements of national policy are drawn from CMO No. 21, s. 2026 as disseminated through CHED Regional Memorandum No. 318, s. 2026, and literature citations from the sources listed in the References.

Summary

This framework sets out how Visayas State University (VSU) will use artificial intelligence (AI) in teaching, learning, research, and administration. Its design choices are deliberate:

- **Enable first.** Faculty are encouraged to use AI agents and assistants to design, deliver, and manage their courses, with minimal approval steps and simple disclosure.
- **Proportionate to risk.** Requirements scale with the risk of the use case (a three-tier model for tools; five levels for course-level AI use) rather than blanket bans or uniform gates.
- **Integrity by design.** Academic integrity is protected mainly through clear course-level AI-use declarations, assessment redesign, and process-based evidence, not detector-driven policing.
- **Fair and lawful.** Student data, privacy, equity, and due process are protected in line with the Data Privacy Act and national higher-education policy.
- **Sustainable.** A small governance structure, an annual review cycle, versioned documents, and a feedback loop keep the framework current without heavy bureaucracy.

The framework is designed to align with CMO No. 21, s. 2026, as disseminated through CHED Regional Memorandum No. 318, s. 2026; Table 1 maps each part to the relevant provisions.

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1 Terms and Abbreviations

These terms and abbreviations are used throughout the framework.

1.1 Abbreviations

AI
Artificial intelligence.

BOR
Board of Regents of the University.

CHED
Commission on Higher Education.

CMO
CHED Memorandum Order; CMO No. 21, s. 2026 is the national framework on AI in higher education.

DPO
Data Protection Officer.

HEI
Higher education institution.

IT
Information Technology.

NPC
National Privacy Commission.

RA
Republic Act.

TWG
Technical Working Group for AI Policy and Governance, the policy owner of this framework.

UADCO
University Administrative Council.

UAC
University Academic Council.

VSU
Visayas State University.

1.2 Terms

AI agent
An AI system that can plan and take actions (e.g., use tools, edit files, send messages) toward a goal with some autonomy.

AI assistant
A conversational or embedded AI system that responds to user prompts.

AI Use Declaration
A short statement accompanying a submission that states whether and how AI was used (Section 7, Appendix A).

AI-use level
A course- or assessment-level declaration (0–4) of how AI may be used.

AI-text detector
Software that estimates whether text was machine-generated; its output is never sufficient on its own as evidence of misconduct.

Authentic assessment
A task resembling real-world work, often contextual and process-visible.

De-identification
Removing or masking information that identifies a person.

Generative AI
AI that produces new content such as text, images, code, audio, or video.

Meaningful human review
Oversight by a qualified person with the authority, competence, and opportunity to understand, question, validate, modify, or override AI-assisted recommendations before consequential decisions are finalized (CMO No. 21, s. 2026, Art. II).

Personal data
Information that identifies or can reasonably identify an individual; see the Data Privacy Act.

Process evidence
Drafts, version history, notes, or reflections showing how work was produced.

Tier A/B/C
The three levels of tool-use review (open, listed, reviewed) in Section 11.

Working days
Days excluding holidays, special non-working days, and days when work is suspended.

2 Purpose, Scope, and Policy Basis

2.1 Purpose

This framework aims to:

(a) empower faculty and staff to use AI effectively and confidently in their professional work;

(b) improve students' learning experience and prepare them for an AI-enabled workplace and society;

(c) protect academic integrity, privacy, and equity through clear, fair, and proportionate rules; and

(d) provide a lightweight, renewable mechanism for governing AI at the University.

2.2 Scope and applicability

The framework applies to all VSU students, faculty, researchers, administrative staff, and external collaborators acting for the University, across all campuses and modalities, when they use AI systems for University work. It covers generative AI (text, image, code, audio, video), AI agents and assistants (e.g., chat-based assistants and coding or workflow agents), analytics and prediction tools, and AI features embedded in other software.

Out of scope: purely personal use of AI that does not involve University work, data, or assessment.

2.3 Policy basis and alignment

The framework is designed to align with:

- CMO No. 21, s. 2026, *Policies, Standards, and Guidelines for the Framework on Artificial Intelligence (AI) in Higher Education* (Commission on Higher Education, 2026), as disseminated to higher education institutions in Eastern Visayas through CHED Regional Memorandum No. 318, s. 2026 (CHED Regional Office VIII, 2026);
- Republic Act No. 10173 (Data Privacy Act of 2012), its Implementing Rules and Regulations, and National Privacy Commission issuances (Republic of the Philippines, 2012);
- existing VSU policies on academic honesty, research ethics, intellectual property, information security, and student discipline.

Where this framework conflicts with national law or CHED issuances, the latter prevail. Where it is silent, existing VSU policies apply. The framework is a university-level instrument that implements the Institutional AI Governance Framework contemplated in Section 14 of CMO No. 21, s. 2026.

Table 1: Alignment map to CMO No. 21, s. 2026.

Framework section	Related provisions of CMO No. 21, s. 2026
Principles (§3)	Sec. 3 (general provisions); Sec. 4 (national guiding principles 1–8).
Governance (§4)	Sec. 14–18 (Institutional AI Governance Framework, high-risk AI, oversight and approval pathways, avoidance of excessive burdens).
Faculty enablement (§5)	Sec. 7(2) (faculty academic freedom); Sec. 9(1) (AI as an academic tool); Sec. 21 (faculty AI literacy and governance training).
Student learning and academic integrity (§6, §7)	Principle 2 (syllabi state when AI use is appropriate, restricted, and disclosed); Sec. 8 (student disclosure); Sec. 9(2) (assessment redesign; detection tools not the sole basis for misconduct).
Data privacy (§8)	Principle 3 (data and AI safeguards; no confidential material in unsecure public platforms); preamble (RA 10173 and NPC issuances).
Equity and literacy (§9)	Principle 1 (access, inclusion, fairness); Principle 2 (questioning and validating AI outputs); Sec. 3(3).
Research and authorship (§10)	Sec. 10–12 (AI-assisted research; disclosure in theses and dissertations; authorship attribution and scholarly responsibility).
Tool approval (§11)	Principle 3 (minimal-, moderate-, and high-impact tools); Sec. 15–17 (high-risk systems and approval).
Implementation (§12)	Sec. 23–25 (phased rollout, reporting, quality assurance); Sec. 30 (twelve-month default transition).

2.4 Authority and interpretation

The policy owner of this framework is the Technical Working Group (TWG) for AI Policy and Governance, led by Dr. Magdalene C. Unajan. Interpretive questions go to the TWG (Section 4).

Approval route: the draft is reviewed concurrently by the University Academic Council (UAC) and the University Administrative Council (UADCO); after their revisions and approval, it is endorsed by the Office of the President to the Board of Regents (BOR) for approval.

3 Guiding Principles

This draft treats pedagogical, governance, and operational concerns together, following the three dimensions of the AI ecological education policy framework proposed by Chan (2023), and is guided by the national principles in CMO No. 21, s. 2026 (Commission on Higher Education, 2026). The following principles guide interpretation of every provision.

1. **Human-centered and accountable.** People, not AI systems, remain responsible for decisions, outputs, grades, and published work. AI supports professional judgment; it does not replace it.
2. **Enabling by default.** Lawful and ethical AI use consistent with course or work objectives is permitted and encouraged without prior approval, unless a higher-risk tier applies.
3. **Proportionality.** Requirements increase only as risk increases (to personal data, assessment validity, or consequential decisions). Low-risk uses carry minimal obligations.
4. **Transparency through simplicity.** Disclosure is expected where AI use affects assessment or authorship, using short standard statements rather than lengthy reports.
5. **Learning first.** Students should still develop the knowledge and skills each course intends. AI use is judged by whether it supports or undermines the learning outcomes.
6. **Integrity through design.** Clear expectations, authentic assessment, and process evidence are preferred to surveillance and detector-driven enforcement; CMO No. 21, s. 2026 provides that detection tools shall not be the sole basis for determining academic misconduct (Sec. 9).
7. **Fairness and inclusion.** Policies must not disadvantage students by language, disability, connectivity, or ability to pay for tools.
8. **Privacy and security.** Personal and confidential data are protected in accordance with law and University policy.
9. **Academic freedom and professional growth.** Faculty exercise professional discretion in course design and are supported to experiment and to learn.
10. **Continuous learning.** AI capabilities and risks change quickly; the framework is reviewed regularly and revised through evidence and feedback.

4 Governance, Roles, and Sustainability

Governance is intentionally lean: few bodies, clear roles, and short decision paths.

4.1 Roles and responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
Policy Owner and governing body: Technical Working Group for AI Policy and Governance (TWG), led by Dr. Magdalene C. Unajan	Owns this framework and is accountable for its content, interpretation, review, and amendment. Also performs the functions of a steering body: reviews Tier C tools and exceptions, handles interpretive questions, and conducts the annual review. The TWG may consult the Data Protection Officer, the Information Technology Office, and faculty and student representatives as needed.
AI Support Desk (function designated by the TWG)	Single point of contact; maintains the tool guidance list, template bank, and shared practice repository; collects feedback and incident reports.
Data Protection Officer (DPO)	Advises on privacy impact for Tier B and C tools and handles personal-data incidents under the Data Privacy Act.
College and Department Heads	Promote adoption, release time for professional development where feasible, and handle first-line questions. They do not add blanket restrictions beyond this framework without TWG consent.
Faculty	Decide AI-use levels for their courses (Section 7), disclose AI use where required, and model responsible practice.
Students	Follow the course AI-use declaration, disclose AI use as required, and verify AI outputs they rely on.
Information Technology Office	Maintains the approved tool list, access arrangements, and security controls.
Student Affairs / Integrity Office	Administers the proportionate process for suspected misuse (Section 7).

4.2 Decision principles

- Course-level AI-use decisions rest with the faculty member within the framework limits.
- Tier A uses need no approval; Tier B requires use of listed tools; Tier C requires TWG review (Section 11).
- The TWG publishes its review turnaround targets (Section 11); working days exclude holidays, special non-working days, and days when work is suspended.

4.3 Document control

- **Policy owner:** Technical Working Group for AI Policy and Governance, led by Dr. Magdalene C. Unajan.
- The framework carries a version number (major.minor), a change log, and an effective date.
- Minor updates (clarifications, tool list changes, template updates) are approved by the TWG and logged. Major changes follow the amendment procedure (Section 12.3).
- Supporting materials (tool list, templates, quick guides) are living documents kept outside the policy text so frequent updates do not require amendment.

4.4 Review cycle and feedback loop

1. **Continuous feedback:** a simple form and the Support Desk collect feedback and incidents year-round.
2. **Semestral check-in:** the Support Desk reports brief metrics and emerging issues to the TWG.
3. **Annual review:** the TWG reviews metrics, feedback, and technological and regulatory developments, and recommends updates.
4. **Triggered review:** a significant legal change, CHED issuance, serious incident, or major technology change prompts an out-of-cycle review.

5 Faculty Enablement

Faculty are the primary drivers of effective AI use in courses. This section removes barriers and provides support.

5.1 Permitted and encouraged uses

Faculty may use AI tools without prior approval (Tier A, Section 11) for, among others:

Teaching and instruction lesson planning; generating examples, case studies, worked solutions, analogies, and practice items; adapting explanations to different levels and languages; building course tutors or study assistants configured on the faculty member's own materials.

Assessment design drafting rubrics, question banks, and scenario-based or authentic tasks; designing AI-resilient and AI-integrated assessments; generating formative feedback prompts; piloting assessments against AI to see how they perform.

Content creation drafting slides, handouts, modules, quizzes, simulations, code samples, and multimedia; translating or localizing materials; producing accessible formats (captions, alt text, plain-language versions).

Course management and administration drafting announcements and correspondence, scheduling, organizing course files, summarizing meetings, preparing reports, and using agents to automate routine, non-sensitive workflow steps.

Feedback and student support drafting comments on student work for faculty review and edit, building FAQs, and creating personalized study plans, provided the data-handling rules in Section 8 are followed.

Research literature exploration, coding and data-analysis support, drafting and editing, and idea generation, subject to Section 10.

5.2 Faculty responsibilities (kept deliberately light)

1. Review and take responsibility for AI-assisted content before use; check facts, citations, and bias.
2. Do not enter personally identifiable student information, grades, or confidential records into non-approved tools (Section 8).
3. AI may assist in grading or feedback, but a faculty member remains accountable for grades and final decisions. Fully automated high-stakes grading is a Tier C use.

4. Declare the AI-use level for each course (Section 7).

5.3 Simple disclosure norms for faculty

Disclosure is not required for routine drafting, editing, or planning support. A one-line note (e.g., "Prepared with AI assistance and reviewed by the instructor") is expected when AI-generated material is presented to students as substantive instructional content, is published, or when students interact directly with an AI system set up for the course.

5.4 Professional development and support

- **Starter pathway:** a short, self-paced orientation on AI capabilities, limits, and responsible use, plus the quick reference in Appendix B.
- **Practice community:** faculty learning circles, show-and-tell sessions, and a shared repository of tested prompts, course agents, assessment designs, and case studies.
- **Mentoring and micro-grants:** peer mentors and small grants or recognition (e.g., for teaching innovation) for faculty who pilot and share AI-enabled course designs.
- **Workload and recognition:** AI-related course redesign, training, and scholarship of teaching count toward professional development and recognition under existing University processes.
- **Well-being:** support to address overload and stress associated with rapid technological change, which research links to reduced performance and innovation (Tarafdar et al., 2014); participation in training is encouraged, not penalized.

5.5 Tool and agent access guidance

- The IT Office maintains a short, regularly updated guidance list of tools by tier, with notes on what data each may receive.
- The University will work toward providing institutional access (e.g., licensed or education-tier assistants and agents) so that access does not depend on individual ability to pay, subject to available resources.
- Where institutional access is unavailable, faculty may use personally held accounts for Tier A purposes only, and are not required to purchase tools.
- Faculty must not require students to buy paid tools or to create accounts that expose their personal data (Section 9).

6 Student Learning and Responsible Use

AI can support personalized learning, writing and brainstorming assistance, and research and analysis, while raising concerns about accuracy, privacy, ethics, and effects on personal development (Chan and Hu, 2023). Reviews also point to opacity, privacy and security, fairness, and reliability as governance challenges (Yu and Guo, 2023), and a validated scale now exists for measuring student dependence on AI (Morales-García et al., 2024). This framework therefore takes a guided rather than prohibitive approach, consistent with the human-centered principles of CMO No. 21, s. 2026.

6.1 Student expectations

Students are expected to:

1. read each course's AI-use declaration and follow it; ask the instructor when unclear;
2. use AI to deepen understanding, not to bypass the learning the course intends;
3. verify AI outputs against reliable sources; they remain responsible for the accuracy of submitted work, including fabricated or incorrect citations;
4. disclose AI use when the course requires it, using a short statement (Appendix A);
5. protect their own and others' personal data when using AI tools; and
6. keep drafts, notes, or AI-chat records that show how work developed, where the course asks for process evidence.

6.2 Learning-enhancing uses

Where a course permits, examples of encouraged student uses include: explaining difficult concepts, generating practice questions, getting feedback on drafts, language support, debugging and code explanation, brainstorming, summarizing readings (followed by reading the source), and organizing study plans.

6.3 Guard against over-reliance

Faculty are encouraged to design activities in which students critique, compare, and improve AI outputs, and to build reflection on how AI use affected learning. Students are encouraged to attempt tasks first before consulting AI when building foundational skills.

6.4 Student voice

Students contribute through the feedback loop and during consultation on major amendments. Annual surveys and focus groups inform revisions.

7 Academic Integrity in the Age of AI

The approach is *clarity, design, evidence, and fairness*: prevent misuse by making expectations clear and assessments robust, and handle suspected misuse proportionately.

7.1 Course-level AI-use levels

Each faculty member declares one of five levels in the syllabus (and may vary it by assessment), consistent with CMO No. 21, s. 2026, which asks that syllabi state when AI use is appropriate, when it is restricted, and how it must be disclosed (Principle 2). The scale is an original VSU proposal.

If a course is silent, **Level 2** applies. This default permits supportive use while keeping authorship with the student, avoiding both a blanket ban and unrestricted generation. An **AI Use Declaration** accompanies every submission of student output, whatever the level; it is a short standard statement (Appendix A), and only Levels 3 and 4 call for more detail. This follows the disclosure requirement of CMO No. 21, s. 2026 (Sec. 8) without requiring full documentation

Table 3: Proposed AI-use levels.

Level	Name	What students may do	Disclosure
0	No AI	Work completed without AI (e.g., in-class, oral, or supervised tasks).	Declaration: "No AI used"; supervised conditions.
1	Study support	AI for understanding, practice, and planning only; no AI-generated text in submitted work.	Declaration: "No AI used in the submission".
2	AI-assisted (default)	AI for brainstorming, feedback, editing, and language support; student authors the substance.	Short statement.
3	AI-collaborative	AI may generate drafts or code that students critique, verify, and revise.	Statement plus process evidence.
4	AI-integrated	AI use is expected and assessed as part of the task.	Full documentation of prompts or workflow.

of every AI use (Sec. 18). Faculty may use the declaration templates in Appendix A and may set different levels for different assessments. Mixed-level courses should state the level beside each assessment.

7.2 Assessment redesign

CMO No. 21, s. 2026 encourages redesigning assessments through authentic, process-based, oral, reflective, performance-based, or contextualized strategies (Sec. 9); research on academic integrity in online assessment likewise reviews design-based approaches to reducing dishonesty (Holden et al., 2021). Faculty are encouraged to:

- match the AI-use level to the learning outcome being assessed (some outcomes, such as foundational skills, merit Level 0 or 1 conditions);
- use authentic, local, and context-specific tasks (e.g., Visayas community cases, field data, course discussions);
- add short oral defenses, in-class checkpoints, or reflections on process and decisions for higher-stakes work;
- stage large assignments (proposal, outline, draft, final) so that development is visible;
- combine lower-stakes open-AI work with a smaller number of supervised assessments; and
- test their own assessments with an AI tool to see what it can and cannot do.

7.3 Process-based evidence

Evidence of authorship is gathered through ordinary teaching activities rather than surveillance: version histories, drafts, annotated sources, short reflection notes, and brief conversations about the work. Students may be asked to explain their work; inability to explain submitted work is a signal for conversation, not proof of misuse.

7.4 Cautions about AI-text detectors

Detection tools, where used, shall not be the sole basis for determining academic misconduct (CMO No. 21, s. 2026, Sec. 9), and CMO No. 21, s. 2026 does not require mandatory AI detection

for every submission (Sec. 18). Therefore:

- detector output **alone shall never** be the basis for a finding of misconduct or a grade penalty;
- detectors are not mandated and the University does not endorse their routine use; and
- any use must be treated as, at most, one weak signal alongside process evidence and a conversation with the student.

7.5 Proportionate and fair handling of suspected misuse

1. **Conversation first.** The instructor discusses the concern with the student and reviews the process evidence. Cases of this kind are intended to be resolved here as educational matters (e.g., unclear declaration, first minor lapse).
2. **Educational outcomes for minor or first-time cases:** revision or resubmission, reduced marks for the affected component, or a learning agreement.
3. **Referral for serious or repeated cases** to the existing student discipline or academic integrity process, with written notice of the concern and evidence.
4. **Due process.** The student receives clear notice, access to the evidence, an opportunity to respond, and a decision by someone other than the original complainant for contested cases, plus an avenue of appeal consistent with existing University procedures. The standard of evidence is the one in existing VSU rules.
5. **Fairness safeguards:** consideration of language background, disability, and the clarity of the declaration in force; no presumption of guilt from use of AI in itself where the declaration permitted it.
6. **Records and learning:** anonymized case data inform training and assessment redesign.

7.6 Misuse that is clearly prohibited

Regardless of level: submitting AI output as one's own work where the declaration prohibits it or requires disclosure and none is made; fabricating data or sources; impersonation in supervised assessments; uploading others' work or confidential materials into AI tools without permission; and using AI to harass, deceive, or create deepfakes of others.

8 Data Privacy and Security

8.1 Legal basis

Processing of personal data in connection with AI is subject to Republic Act No. 10173 (Data Privacy Act of 2012), its Implementing Rules and Regulations, and National Privacy Commission issuances (Republic of the Philippines, 2012). CMO No. 21, s. 2026 directs that confidential or sensitive materials must not be uploaded to unsecure public AI platforms and that standards for data handling, cybersecurity, and vendor compliance be institutionalized (Principle 3). The University treats privacy as a core design constraint; information-privacy research centers on individuals' desire to control data about themselves (Bélanger and Crossler, 2011).

Table 4: Data classes and where they may be used with AI tools.

Class	Examples	Permitted AI use
Public / non-personal	Published materials, own lecture notes, generic questions	Any tool (Tier A).
Internal	Draft policies, unpublished course materials, internal memos	Tier A tools acceptable if no personal data and no confidentiality restriction; otherwise listed (Tier B) tools.
Personal data	Names, student numbers, contact details, grades, attendance, submitted work with identifiers	Only Tier B/C tools with data-protection terms vetted by the DPO; de-identify wherever possible.
Sensitive / confidential	Disciplinary, health, financial, or other sensitive personal information; exam content before use; unpublished research with restrictions	Not entered into external AI tools unless a Tier C approval specifically permits it.

8.2 Data classes and handling rules

8.3 Practical rules

1. **De-identify first:** remove names, IDs, and other identifiers from student work or data before using general tools, where the purpose permits.
2. **Data minimization and purpose limitation:** share only what the task requires.
3. **Student work as intellectual property:** faculty do not upload identifiable student work to a tool that retains or trains on inputs without the student's informed consent or a vetted institutional arrangement.
4. **Settings and terms:** use available privacy settings (e.g., opt out of training on inputs); consult the Tier list for known terms.
5. **Transparency to students:** when students must use a course-provided AI tool, tell them what data is collected, why, and for how long; offer a non-AI or alternative path where feasible.
6. **Incident reporting:** suspected disclosure of personal data to an AI tool is reported promptly to the DPO for assessment under applicable breach-notification rules.
7. **Security hygiene:** protect accounts, avoid pasting credentials or keys into prompts, and review permissions granted to AI agents (e.g., access to email, files, or code repositories) using least privilege.

8.4 AI agents with system access

Agents that can act on files, mail, calendars, learning-management systems, or code require extra care: grant minimum permissions, review actions before irreversible steps, and keep a record of what the agent was allowed to do. Agents with access to personal or confidential University data are Tier B or C.

9 Equity, Accessibility, and AI Literacy

9.1 Equity of access

- No student is required to purchase an AI tool or subscription. Where a course expects AI use (Levels 3–4), the faculty member ensures an accessible institutional or free option exists, or provides an alternative.
- The University will consider connectivity and device constraints, especially for students in low-bandwidth areas, by offering offline-friendly alternatives and on-campus access points where resources allow.
- Policies must not disadvantage non-native English writers or students using assistive technologies.

9.2 Accessibility

AI is encouraged as an accessibility aid (captioning, transcription, text-to-speech, simplification, translation). Use of AI for disability accommodation does not count as a violation of any AI-use level and is not required to be disclosed beyond what is needed to arrange the accommodation. Course materials produced with AI should be checked for accessibility.

9.3 Bias and responsible interpretation

Users are reminded that AI outputs can reflect bias, be inaccurate, or omit local and cultural context. CMO No. 21, s. 2026 asks that students learn to question AI tools, validate outputs, recognize bias, and understand limitations (Principle 2). Course activities should include critical evaluation of outputs, including relevance to Philippine and Visayan contexts and languages.

9.4 AI literacy

- **Students:** AI literacy is integrated into orientation and general-education or discipline courses: how AI works at a basic level, capabilities and limits, prompting, verification, ethics, privacy, and disclosure.
- **Faculty and staff:** see Section 5 for development pathways.
- **Everyone:** a short, shared orientation and the quick-reference guides (Appendix B) provide a common baseline.

9.5 Wellbeing

Users are encouraged to be aware of overload and stress from rapid technology change; wellbeing supports are available through existing University services.

10 Research and Authorship Ethics

10.1 Permitted research uses

Researchers may use AI to explore literature, draft and edit text, write and debug analysis code, summarize and organize notes, and generate ideas, subject to journal, funder, and ethics-committee requirements, which prevail when stricter.

10.2 Authorship and accountability

1. AI systems cannot be authors; human authors take full responsibility for content, accuracy, originality, and citations. CMO No. 21, s. 2026 requires clarity on human scholarly responsibility and accountability and allows institutions to specify whether and how AI tools may be acknowledged, provided acknowledgment does not displace human responsibility (Sec. 12). Publisher and funder policies apply in addition and should be checked for each target venue.
2. Disclose substantive AI use (e.g., generation of text, analysis, or images) in the methods or acknowledgments, naming the tool and how it was used. Routine spelling or grammar assistance need not be disclosed unless the publisher requires it.
3. Verify every AI-supplied reference and claim against the primary source; fabricated references are research misconduct when published.
4. Maintain research records sufficient for reproducibility, including AI-assisted analysis steps.

10.3 Confidentiality in research and review

Do not upload confidential manuscripts, grant proposals, peer-review materials, interview transcripts, or participant data to external AI tools without authorization and ethics clearance (Section 8).

10.4 Student theses and dissertations

Disclosure of AI use in theses and dissertations is required (CMO No. 21, s. 2026, Sec. 11), using the format in Appendix A. Programs may set AI-use levels for thesis work; defaults follow Section 7. Advisers and students agree in writing at the outset on permitted AI use and disclosure, and the student remains responsible for authorship and defense of the work.

10.5 Research ethics review

Research that develops or deploys AI systems affecting human participants, or that uses AI on human-subject data, follows existing research ethics review, with the Tier C pathway applying to high-risk systems (Section 11). Authorship and intellectual property follow existing University policies.

11 Tool Approval and Procurement

A simple three-tier pathway keeps low-risk adoption frictionless and reserves scrutiny for high-risk uses.

11.1 Principles for the tool list

- Maintain the list as a living document, updated by the Support Desk; do not duplicate reviews across colleges.
- Prefer tools with clear data-protection terms, no training on University inputs, export options, and accessibility features.
- Record vendor, version, data location, retention, and review date for Tier B and C tools.

Table 5: Tiered pathway for AI tools and uses.

Tier	Typical use	Process	Turnaround
A: Open	Public or non-personal data; individual drafting, planning, content creation; general-purpose assistants and agents with no access to University systems or data.	No approval; follow principles and guidance list.	Immediate.
B: Listed	Uses involving personal or internal data; course-wide tools students must use; agents with limited access to University accounts.	Use tools on the Tier B list; if a tool is absent, submit a one-page request (purpose, data, vendor terms) to the Support Desk; IT and DPO conduct a light review.	Target 25 working days; tools reviewed once are listed for all.
C: Reviewed	High-stakes or high-risk: automated decisions affecting students or staff (admissions, grading, faculty evaluation, scholarship eligibility, discipline, proctoring, early warning); use of sensitive data; institution-wide deployment or procurement; systems built or fine-tuned on University data.	TWG review including privacy impact assessment, security review, bias and accessibility check, human-oversight plan, meaningful human review of final decisions, and pilot/evaluation criteria.	Target 50 working days.

- Procurement follows applicable government procurement law and University procurement rules.
- Prohibited: tools with unacceptable security or privacy practices, and uses that are unlawful, discriminatory, or deceptive (e.g., covert emotion recognition or biometric surveillance without lawful basis and Tier C approval).

11.2 Exceptions and pilots

Faculty and units may run time-limited pilots of new tools for Tier B use with a short notice to the Support Desk, to be reviewed afterwards. Pilots are encouraged and are intended to feed the list.

12 Implementation, Monitoring, and Amendment

12.1 Implementation roadmap (proposed)

Phase	Key actions
Phase 0: Approve (Months 0–1)	Concurrent review by the University Academic Council and University Administrative Council; revisions; endorsement by the Office of the President to the Board of Regents for approval; designate the Support Desk.

Phase	Key actions
Phase 1: Launch (Months 1–3)	Publish framework, quick-reference guides, and templates; initial Tier list; orientation sessions; require course AI-use declarations from the next term; open the feedback channel.
Phase 2: Build capacity (Months 3–9)	Faculty learning circles, practice repository, mentoring and pilot grants; student AI-literacy orientation; first institutional access arrangements; privacy-impact templates.
Phase 3: Embed (Months 9–12)	Assessment redesign support; integrate into syllabus templates and learning management system; first annual review and v1.1 revision.
Phase 4: Sustain (Year 2 onward)	Annual review cycle; continuous updates to living documents; periodic benchmarking and external alignment checks.

12.2 Monitoring metrics

Metrics are chosen to be few and collectable with little effort; they inform improvement, not individual evaluation.

Area	Indicators
Adoption	Share of courses with an AI-use declaration; share of faculty who have completed the starter orientation; number of shared practice resources.
Faculty experience	Short pulse survey on usefulness, confidence, and perceived burden of the framework.
Student experience	Survey on clarity of expectations, perceived fairness, and learning support.
Integrity	Number and type of cases, share resolved at the educational stage, appeals, and outcomes; no use of detector-only findings.
Privacy and security	Number of reported incidents and time to resolution; share of Tier B requests processed within target.
Equity	Access gaps reported; accommodation requests relating to AI.
Governance	Review turnaround, number of Tier C decisions, and policy updates.

12.3 Amendment procedure

1. **Proposal:** any member of the University community may propose an amendment through the Support Desk.
2. **Screening:** the TWG classifies the proposal as minor (clarification, tool list, template) or major (principles, tiers, integrity or due-process provisions, roles).
3. **Minor changes:** approved by the TWG, logged, and published.
4. **Major changes:** brief consultation with faculty, students, and staff, then TWG endorsement and approval through the same route as the framework (University Academic Council and University Administrative Council, then the Board of Regents through the Office of the President).
5. **Publication:** each version is dated, numbered, and accompanied by a change summary; the previous version is archived.

12.4 Transitional provisions

For the first term after approval, course declarations are encouraged but not penalized if late; cases arising before a declaration was available are handled educationally. CMO No. 21, s. 2026 sets a default transition period of twelve months, extendable by institutions to eighteen to twenty-four months where readiness warrants (Sec. 30); the roadmap above is designed to fit within twelve months.

A Course AI-Use Declaration Templates

Faculty may paste one of these into the syllabus or assessment brief and adapt freely.

A.1 Course-level declaration (short form)

AI use in this course. Unless stated otherwise for a specific assessment, this course follows **Level** _____ of the VSU AI-use levels: _____.
Permitted: _____
Not permitted: _____
Disclosure required with every submission: ☐ "No AI used" statement ☐ Short statement ☐ Statement and process evidence ☐ Full documentation
Why: (link to the learning outcome) _____
Ask me if unsure before you submit. Using AI within these rules is not misconduct.

A.2 Per-assessment table

Assessment	Level (0–4)	Disclosure	Notes (e.g., supervised, oral check)

A.3 Student AI Use Declaration (every submission)

AI disclosure. I used _____ (tool) for _____ (purpose, e.g., brainstorming, feedback, language editing, code explanation). I reviewed and verified the output, and the final work reflects my own understanding. ☐ I did not use AI for this work.

A.4 Process-evidence note (Levels 3–4)

(1) Key prompts or interactions (or a link/export): _____
(2) What I changed or rejected from the AI output and why: _____
(3) How I checked accuracy and sources: _____
(4) What I learned or would do differently: _____

A.5 Faculty disclosure line (instructional materials)

This material was prepared with AI assistance and reviewed and edited by the instructor.

B Quick-Reference Guides

B.1 Faculty: one-page guide

Go ahead Use AI for planning, content, rubrics, feedback drafts, admin work, and research support. No approval needed for non-personal data.

Declare Put an AI-use level (0–4) in your syllabus; Level 2 applies if you say nothing.

Design Match assessments to outcomes; stage work; add short oral or in-class checks for high stakes; test your tasks with AI.

Protect data De-identify student data; use Tier B tools for personal data; never paste confidential records into unlisted tools.

Own the result Review AI output; you remain accountable for grades and content.

Handle concerns Talk to the student first; use process evidence; never rely on an AI detector alone.

Get help Contact the Support Desk; join the practice community; share what works.

B.2 Students: one-page guide

Read Check each course's AI-use level and each assignment's notes; ask if unclear.

Use to learn Use AI to understand, practice, and improve, not to skip the learning.

Check Verify facts and sources; you are responsible for what you submit.

Disclose Attach a short AI Use Declaration to every submission ("No AI used" if none); keep drafts and notes.

Protect Do not upload others' personal data or confidential materials; mind your own privacy.

If accused You will be heard: you can explain your process, see the evidence, and appeal.

Need access? Tell your instructor if you cannot access a required tool.

B.3 Which tier?

Question	Answer
Only public/non-personal data and no access to University systems?	Tier A: go ahead.
Personal/internal data, or a tool all students must use?	Tier B: use listed tool or request.
Automated decisions about people, sensitive data, or institution-wide rollout?	Tier C: request review.

C Sources Consulted

Statements of national policy in this draft were checked against the issued texts of CMO No. 21, s. 2026 (Commission on Higher Education, 2026) and CHED Regional Memorandum No. 318, s. 2026 (CHED Regional Office VIII, 2026). Literature citations were checked against the full texts of the works listed in the References, and claims attributed to them are limited to what those works report. Where a source could not be consulted, no claim is attributed to it.

Matters of VSU practice (roles, review targets, approval route, and AI-use levels) are proposals of the Technical Working Group for AI Policy and Governance and are submitted to the panel for review.

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